Activity A3 - Build the Compliance Obligations Register

Course: Fundamentals of ISO 14001 Environmental Management System (EMS) (TGS-2023037592) Ability: A4 Objective: Determine applicable obligations, ownership, evidence and escalation routes without making unsupported legal conclusions. Mode: Team analysis with individual evidence submission Suggested time: 60 minutes

Scenario

MEP holds licences and service contracts in separate folders. A customer code, wastewater conditions, hazardous-substance storage controls and waste records are not linked to process owners or evidence.

Meridian EcoPack Pte Ltd (MEP) is a fictional Singapore SME with 120 employees producing printed corrugated and fibre-based packaging for regional food, electronics and healthcare customers. Two key customers require evidence of an ISO 14001:2026-aligned EMS and stronger value-chain environmental controls before contract renewal.

Task and expected output

Screen MEP's activities against Singapore environmental obligation categories, customer commitments and permit conditions.

Produce: A compliance obligations register, applicability rationale, evidence map and escalation log.

Before you begin

- Open a working copy of the Excel workbook; do not overwrite the supplied evidence.
- Allocate a facilitator, evidence recorder, checker and presenter.
- Read every evidence card before making a compliance or significance conclusion.
- If the activity concerns an incident, this is a tabletop exercise: do not handle chemicals or simulate unsafe physical actions.

Decision questions

1. Which obligations are mandatory, which are voluntary commitments and which require specialist confirmation?
2. How does each obligation apply to a specific aspect, activity, site or contractor?
3. What evidence demonstrates current status and who must be told when a potential breach is found?

Detailed procedure

Step 1 - List each significant aspect and identify possible statutory, permit, contract, customer and voluntary sources

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 2 - Consult current authoritative sources and record the source, issue date, review date and responsible reviewer

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 3 - Write a plain-language applicability statement and link the obligation to process, aspect and control

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 4 - Define evidence, frequency, owner, evaluator and escalation route; mark any item requiring legal or technical advice

Define evidence, frequency, owner, evaluator and escalation route; mark any item requiring legal or technical advice.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 5 - Test three sample records against the stated obligation and record compliant, noncompliant or insufficient-evidence status

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 6 - Schedule change monitoring and a periodic formal evaluation of compliance

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Evidence to submit

- Completed Activity-A3-Workbook.xlsx.
- One evidence-backed team decision and one documented peer challenge.
- Any assumption or missing source clearly labelled for follow-up.

Acceptance checklist

[ ] Every register row has a source, applicability rationale, owner, evidence, review frequency and escalation route; unresolved interpretation is escalated rather than guessed.

[ ] Claims are traceable to supplied or cited evidence.

[ ] Assumptions, uncertainty and missing evidence are labelled.

[ ] Owners, due dates and next decisions are included where applicable.

[ ] Legal/compliance interpretations needing competent advice are escalated rather than guessed.

[ ] A peer challenge and response are recorded.

Troubleshooting

- The team cannot agree on a score: return to the criterion anchors and record each evidence-based assumption before averaging or escalating.
- Evidence is missing: do not invent it; record an evidence gap, risk implication, owner and retrieval action.
- A legal requirement is unclear: record the current authoritative source and escalate to a competent adviser or authority channel.

- A conclusion feels obvious: test an alternative explanation and state what evidence would falsify the current view.

Facilitator debrief

Ask each team to defend one priority, control or conclusion using objective evidence. Probe what would change the decision, then connect the work to PDCA and the relevant EMS process rather than clause memorisation.

Files in this activity pack

- README.md and README.pdf - detailed learner procedure.
- Activity-A3-Scenario-and-Checklist.pdf - printable scenario and completion checklist.
- Activity-A3-Workbook.xlsx - editable analysis and submission workbook.

Source and usage note

This fictional training activity paraphrases ISO 14001 concepts and is not legal advice or a reproduction of the standard. Use the organisation's licensed ISO 14001:2026 copy and current authoritative Singapore sources for formal interpretation.